

Gee, I Like Your Desktop!



The newly released version KDE 4.2 stands out because it offers a fantastic desktop experience.

While your system boots the live CD (built on top of an openSUSE 11.1 base), you will be looking at that same old dull green boot screen of openSUSE. Wondering why I am picking on openSUSE's default theme again this month? Well, that's because the KDE 4.2 Live CD, which is bundled with this issue of *LFT*, is based on it. Thankfully, once the desktop loads up, you are greeted by the default look and feel of the official desktop release. That's the desktop shell dubbed Plasma by the way, whose job it is to let you organise your desktop pretty much the way you want it.

Oxygen: Breathe in, breathe out!

Yes, that default look and feel that KDE 4.2 comes with is thanks to something called Oxygen—the theme, the window borders

and those beautiful icons. The noticeable change this time round is the desktop panel, which is now a shade of blue—much prettier, I must add.

The panel

The panel has the usual stuff—the KDE (Kickoff) menu, the *Show desktop* utility, the pager (or the workspace switcher), the task manager, device notifier and system tray, followed by the clock. I don't remember if that's the exact order of things, by default, but that's how I like it. If you're on a laptop, the panel should also have the battery monitor next to the system tray.

Apart from a new icon for the device notifier, the utility that has attracted a significant amount of attention from developers is the system tray—the thing that generally holds the KMix (sound